

Calcium Rich Foods

Bone-Building Nutrients Beyond Dairy

Calcium is the most abundant mineral in the body. It is essential for bone and tooth structure, muscle contraction, blood clotting, and nerve signaling. While dairy products are the most common source, many non-dairy foods also provide calcium.

Why Calcium Is Important

Bones act as a reservoir for calcium. When dietary intake is low, the body draws calcium from bones, which over time can weaken them. Adequate intake throughout life, combined with vitamin D and physical activity, supports bone strength.

Dairy and Non-Dairy Sources

Dairy foods such as milk, curd, and cheese are concentrated sources. Plant-based options include leafy greens, sesame seeds, almonds, and fortified plant milks. Ragi (finger millet) is a notable grain source of calcium.

Suggested Items:

- Milk - approximately 300 mg per cup
- Curd (yogurt) - approximately 300 mg per cup
- Ragi flour - approximately 350 mg per 100 g
- Sesame seeds - approximately 100 mg per tablespoon
- Almonds - approximately 75 mg per ounce
- Amaranth leaves - approximately 200 mg per cup cooked

Reference Table

Food	Calcium (mg)	Serving
Milk	300	1 cup
Curd	300	1 cup
Ragi flour	350	100 g
Sesame seeds	100	1 tbsp
Almonds	75	1 ounce

Conclusion

Vitamin D is needed for calcium absorption. Spending time in sunlight and eating vitamin D-rich foods supports calcium use in the body.